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## MEMORANDUM

**TO:** James P. Leonard, Commissioner of Records  
**FROM:** Irwin "Sonny" Popowsky, Chair, Philadelphia Water, Sewer and Storm Water Rate Board  
*Irwin Popowsky*  
**DATE:** July 1, 2026  
**SUBJECT:** 2026 TAP-R Reconciliation Proceeding – Determination of Water Department Tiered Assistance Program Rate Rider Surcharge Rates Beginning 9/1/2026

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Pursuant to Section 13-101 of the Philadelphia Code and the Regulations of the Philadelphia Water, Sewer and Storm Water Rate Board (Rate Board), and at the direction of the Rate Board in its public meeting of July 1, 2026, I am forwarding herewith for filing the Rate Determination on the 2026 TAP-R Reconciliation Proceeding – FY 2027, which constitutes the Rate Report and Rate Determination of the Rate Board; along with a memorandum of approval from the Law Department. The Rate Board hereby authorizes changes in Water Department rates and charges to take effect on September 1, 2026.

On Marcy 19, 2026, following Advance Notice filed with City Council and the Rate Board, the Water Department filed a "Formal Notice of Proposed Changes in Rates and Charges; Annual Adjustment of Tiered Assistance Program Rate Rider Surcharge Rates (TAP-R); Final Proposed TAP-R Reconciliation Statement," commencing a TAP-R Reconciliation Proceeding as defined in Section I(v) of the Rate Board's Regulations.

In accordance with the Charter, Code, and Regulations noted above, the Rate Board's Hearing Officer held a procedural conference and supervised discovery among the four entities and one individual registered as participants in the rate proceeding. A public input hearing was held on this matter on May 7, 2026, and a technical hearing was held on May 14, 2026. The Water Department and Public Advocate filed a Joint Petition for Settlement of TAP-R Proceeding on June 3, 2026.

On June 15, 2026, the Hearing Officer filed her Report, summarizing the record and making recommendations for the resolution of the proceeding. The record of this proceeding is posted on the Rate Board's website on the 2026 TAP-R Reconciliation page, <https://www.phila.gov/departments/water-sewer-storm-water-rate-board/rate-proceedings/2026-tap-r-reconciliation-proceeding/> . The Rate Board then deliberated the issues in a public meeting on June 24, 2026, and adopted the attached Rate Determination at a public meeting on July 1, 2026, by a majority vote of Board Members. All meetings and hearings were duly noticed.

We expect that the Water Department will timely file Rates and Charges in conformance with the Rate Determination. A date-stamped copy of this Rate Determination will also be posted on the above site when received from the Department of Records.

Attachments:        Law Department Approval Memo  
                             Rate Determination, 2026 TAP-R Reconciliation Proceeding